



CENTERSTONE

PROCEDURES FOR TELEHEALTH:
CENTERSTONE TENNESSEE

Centerstone Telehealth Policy

Telehealth is defined as the delivery of healthcare services using interactive electronic communications and information technology (including secure audio-visual conferencing, secure audio communications, store-and-forward technology or remote patient monitoring technology) between a provider in one location and a patient in another location.

Centerstone recognizes that telehealth is an accessible, appropriate, and efficient means for delivering behavioral health services in appropriate cases. While it does not replace “in person” services being offered and provided by Centerstone, telehealth shall be considered as a viable way to provide needed behavioral health services in particular situations.

Centerstone is committed to using telehealth to deliver behavioral health services to its patients and clients in a manner that serves their behavioral service needs, maintains high quality clinical care standards, and ensures both privacy and security of communications.

Privacy for the client served must be maintained at both the client-interface location as well as the provider location in compliance with HIPAA standards and SAMHSA requirements codified at 42 CFR Part 2. Providers shall ensure that they are in a location that will ensure the privacy and confidentiality of the telehealth services provided.

(See Policy: 04.017. AM Telehealth Services)

Centerstone Outpatient Clinics will offer telehealth services to clients who are unable to be seen in person and those who request telehealth services and are deemed appropriate for this method of service delivery.

Access to Telehealth

Referral for telehealth will generally occur following a face to face intake appointment at the local clinic. When deemed necessary, some intakes may be conducted via telehealth under the guidance of the clinic manager.

All staff members (support staff, THL/CM, therapists/med providers including clinic nurses) will **attest** to a review of telehealth SOP document and the clinic's general policies to be able to describe how it is utilized and offered. All clinical staff will be required to complete the Relias training entitled: **Ethical and Legal Guidelines for Telehealth Service Delivery, at hire and annually thereafter.**

Inclusion Requirements

All clients will:

- Be screened for clinical appropriateness of telehealth services at intake and when engaged in ongoing therapy, psychiatric and case management services. Enrollment in telehealth for a treatment episode is at the discretion of the provider and/or supervisory clinical staff. At any point within the treatment episode the client, or provider, may decide that in-person sessions are more clinically appropriate. Failure to comply with telehealth agreements may also result in termination of the telehealth appointments and suggested in-person appointments.
- Be provided with access to the Telehealth Guidelines for Clients document outlining expectations (*see appendix A*) and verbal acknowledgement of these guidelines should be documented in the EHR.
- Be located within the state in which the provider or their clinical supervisor is independently licensed.
 - NOTE: approval for School Based staff to provide services to a client residing temporarily out of state must be granted by Compliance.
- Undergo an informed consent procedure and sign the Centerstone Consent for Treatment (*see Appendix B*) documented at the first session.
- Understand both routine and emergency contact procedures and protocols for the clinic.

If the client is at an intake clinic and a telehealth session is needed, local support staff will complete all consents as part of the front desk bundle and confirm the identity of the client taken to the telehealth room.

Exclusionary Considerations

Although there are no absolute exclusionary criteria to the use of telehealth, the following represent situations when staff may decline to offer telehealth services:

- Actively intoxicated or unwilling/unable to participate in therapy sessions will not be seen over video.
- Immediate risk of self-harm, suicidality, or harm to others and unwilling/unable to safety plan
- Presence of psychiatric symptoms that could be exacerbated by the use of telehealth
- Lack of a private and/or safe environment in which the client can conduct telehealth sessions
- Certain hearing, visual or cognitive deficits that limit the ability to communicate via this technology
- Failure to comply with telehealth agreements/guidelines for conducting sessions
- Clients who may not be developmentally appropriate
- Lack of reliable technology platforms to support telehealth services

CLINIC SCHEDULING AND APPOINTMENTS

If a client expresses interest in receiving services virtually, the therapist or, if needed a case manager or member of the support staff, will ensure they have been given access to the Telehealth Guidelines for Clients, and educate them about the use of Zoom prior to scheduling them for a virtual appointment.

AVATAR DOCUMENTATION

Providers must ensure all telehealth encounters are documented as such in the EHR in full with each progress note containing evidence of the following:

At the **initial** telehealth contact:

- the treating clinician will request the client show a photo ID if they have not seen the client face to face prior to the visit
- Document discussion of the use, risks and benefits of telehealth, as well as safety and contact procedures, and limits of confidentiality

At all subsequent sessions confirm the following within the progress note in the EHR:

- Time, Date and the fact that session was a telehealth session/done over televideo (Avatar)
- Provider location (Avatar)
- Confirm client location (Avatar, document location if not at home)
- Confirm client phone number at the time session

TECHNICAL FAILURES EMERGENCY PROCEDURES AND PROTOCOLS

Technical Failures:

If at any time during the telehealth activities the connection is severed, the clinician will contact the client by phone. In speaking with the client, the clinician can either finish the clinic session via phone or reschedule the client for a later session. This will be at the

determination of the clinician and client and be documented in the note. Before ending a session with a client by phone, the clinician will assess whether an emergency psychiatric condition is present that may require further evaluation.

Be sure the EHR telehealth session information is accessible and make sure the appropriate contact information is filled in and available in case of a technical failure.

**Any technical failure causing the session to be a duration less than 15 minutes should not be billed.*

Emergency Procedures

At the initial telehealth session, the provider educates the client about the need to develop an emergency contact plan that will include, at a minimum:

- The client's phone number and location, including town/county
- This should be verified at every session for safety

A psychiatric emergency will be defined as client reports of:

1. New suicidal thoughts or homicidal thoughts that are causing distress to the client or an impulse or plan to act upon any such thoughts without endorsing the ability to maintain safety.
2. Grossly impaired behavior due to a mental illness (such as taking care of one's basic needs, e.g.).

Ultimately, whether something constitutes a psychiatric/mental health emergency is at the clinical judgment of the provider. General circumstances that constitute a psychiatric emergency may differ from client to client but should be managed the same as an in-person session.

All clinical staff will be familiar with the following:

- Process Document for Referral to Crisis Services (see appendix C)
- Contact information for and dispatch in the county in which the client is located (*see appendix D*) and Mobile Crisis (*see appendix E and F*)

In-Session Management:

If the client and provider are not at the same location, the provider should call the front desk of the clinic where the client is located. (see appendix C)

- Therapist, Clinic Manager, Office Manager should contact local emergency services, and remain engaged and available to the client and local emergency services. Clinicians should follow regular clinic procedures similar to in-person services as it relates to crisis management during a session.

Outside-of-Session Management: If a client notifies their clinician of an emergency situation outside of a session, the clinician should follow regular clinic procedures similar to in-person services. (see Access to Emergency Services Policy 13.081 TN)

Reportable Events

All clinicians will follow state regulations for reporting abuse (e.g., child, elder) and imminent risk according to their licensure.

All clinicians will additionally follow Centerstone's policy regarding incident reporting (*see Centerstone Policies and Procedures Manual; Policy 15.030.TN*).

APPENDIX A

TELEHEALTH GUIDELINES for CLIENTS

- Similar to in-person therapy, telehealth services will include treatment planning and completion of assessments.
- I agree to be alone during session unless otherwise previously agreed upon with my mental health provider due to the sensitive material that is covered in each session, and to respect the confidentiality of my treatment.
- I will inform my provider at the start of each session if I am NOT located in Tennessee at the time of the session
- I will not video/audio record the session without discussion with my provider.
- I will not engage in telehealth therapy while I am driving or in a public area (store, doctor's office, or other public place).
- I will call my provider if I am running late.
- I agree to dress as if I was going to an appointment at the clinic.
- I will work to have my sessions in a private room with minimal distractions.
- I will not engage in other activities during session (e.g., cooking, eating, and smoking.) Drinking nonalcoholic beverages is acceptable.
- I will not attend sessions while under the influence of alcohol or illicit drugs.
- If I am receiving medication services, I understand that I will be asked to come to the clinic for nurse visits for AIMS/Vitals/Labs as requested by my provider
- I understand that my provider may determine therapy services may be better offered via in-person care if there are ongoing challenges with technology or treatment goals to ensure I am receiving the best care possible.

APPENDIX B

CENTERSTONE CONSENT TO TREATMENT

I hereby seek and consent to take part in the treatment provided by Centerstone. I understand that developing a treatment plan with my therapist and regularly reviewing our work toward meeting the treatment goals are in my best interest. I agree to play an active role in this process.

I understand that after my treatment with Centerstone begins, I have the right to refuse or express choice regarding the services I receive, for any reason. However, I will make every effort to discuss my concerns about my progress with my treating professional before ending therapy. The only thing I will still be responsible for is paying for the services I have already received. I understand that I may lose other services or may have to deal with other problems if I stop treatment.

(For example, if my treatment has been court-ordered, I will have to answer to the court.)

I understand that my appointment times are being reserved for me and that efficiency of scheduling often depends on my keeping my appointment as scheduled. I understand that repeated missed appointments may delay my treatment progress and failure to cancel 24 hours before an appointment may result in a fee being added to my account.

I understand that my services may be provided in person or through telehealth, depending on circumstances and my individual needs.

If I am a TennCare recipient, I understand that I am eligible for transportation services. I can consult my Benefits guide for more information or contact the TennCare Advocacy Line at 1-800-758-1638. The transportation provider for this area may be reached at:

- AMERICHoice: Tennessee Carriers: 1-866-405-0238
- AMERIGROUP: Tennessee Carriers: 1-866-405-0238
- BlueCare or TNCare Select: Southeast Transportation: 1-866-473-7565 or 1-866-570-9445

I am aware that an agent of my insurance company, or other third-party payer, may be given information about the type(s), cost(s), date(s), and providers of any services or treatments I receive. This information may be shared until all claims are processed for this treatment episode. I also request payment be made to Centerstone. I understand that if payment for the services I receive here is not made, the therapist may stop my treatment.

My signature below indicates that I have received:

- ☐ Copy of the TennCare Kids Brochure (If applicable)
- ☐ Orientation to services including health and safety features as applicable at clinic locations
- ☐ Copy of my rights and responsibilities via either the Centerstone Client Resource Guide or the annual Client Rights Update

I, the undersigned, agree and consent to participate in the mental health services offered, which may include service provided by telehealth methods.

Printed Client Name	Client ID Number	Date of Birth	Age
Signature of Client/Guardian/Conservator		Date	

***For purposes of consent, unless declared incompetent, individuals ages 16 and over have the legal right to consent to mental health treatment.

APPENDIX C

Referral to Crisis Services

Recommended process regarding how to respond when a client reports during a session that they are at risk of harming themselves/others and a crisis assessment is needed:

Please note: Non-Centerstone Crisis Teams may require to speak with the individual at risk.

- ❖ **When a therapist or medical staff are seeing a client and it is determined that a crisis assessment is needed:**
 - Therapist:
 - Should call the crisis triage line to report a crisis assessment is needed.
 - Medical staff:
 - Should call the front desk/clinic manager to ask for assistance. If the client and provider are not at the same location, they should call the **front desk of the clinic where the client is located.**
 - The minimal information needed to begin the process is client name, DOB, location and brief statement of why assessment is needed (client is: suicidal, homicidal, psychotic). In addition, the crisis staff will ask for a callback name and number (recommend clinic manager/designee)
 - This information can be provided by any staff and triage staff can proceed with dispatch
- ❖ A list of all office front desk phone numbers as well as the crisis number (Appendix E/F) will be provided to Office Managers for distribution to all staff.
 - The provider must share client name, DOB, location of client and reason for assessment with the support staff. In addition, the crisis staff will ask for a callback name and number (recommend clinic manager/designee)
 - Support staff should notify the clinic manager
- ❖ Call placed to crisis triage to initiate assessment; available staff will remain with client for their safety while awaiting MCRT as determined by clinic manager or their designee
- ❖ If there is threat of imminent harm to client, such as a report that they took an OD prior to arrival or they make an attempt to harm themselves while at the office, 911 should be contacted immediately and if crisis triage was previously alerted they should be told that 911 was contacted and is on the way.

APPENDIX D

NON-EMERGENCY CONTACT FOR TN COUNTIES TENNESSEE LAW ENFORCEMENT DISPATCH NUMBERS

ANDERSON	865-457-2414	HANCOCK	423-733-2249	OBION	731-885-0277
BEDFORD	931-684-1530	HARDEMAN	731-658-3971	OVERTON	931-823-5635
BENTON	731-584-4622	HARDOM	731-925-5501	PERRY	931-589-3911
BLEDSE	423-447-2197	HAWKINS	423-272-4848	PICKETT	931-864-3210
BLOUNT	865-273-5000	HAYWOOD	731-772-1260	POLK	423-338-2112
BRADLEY	423-728-7300	HENDERSON	731-968-7777	PUTNAM	931-526-9999
CAMPBELL	423-562-7446	HENRY	731-642-1672	RHEA	423-775-2442
CANNON	615-563-1000	HICKMAN	931-729-5146	ROANE	865-376-5582
CARROLL	731-986-8947	HOUSTON	931-721-4019	ROBERTSON	615-384-4911
CARTER	423-542-1845	HUMPHREYS	931-296-7792	RUTHERFORD	615-898-7770
CHEATHAM	615-792-2098	JACKSON	931-268-0180	SCOTT	423-663-3111
CHESTER	731-989-2787	JEFFERSON	865-397-9411	SEQUATCHIE	423-949-7750
CLAIRBORNE	423-626-3385	JEFFERSON	865-475-2002	SEVIER	865-463-4668
CLAY	931-243-3266	JOHNSON	423-727-7761	SHELBY	901-379-7625
COCKE	423-623-6004	KNOX	865-215-2444	SMITH	615-735-2626
COFFEE	931-728-9555	LAKE	731-253-7791	STEWART	931-232-5322
CROCKET	731-696-2104	LAUDERDALE	731-635-1311	SULLIVAN	423-279-7500
CUMBERLAND	931-484-6176	LAWRENCE	931-762-0450	SUMNER	615-452-2616
DAVIDSON	615-862-8600	LEWIS	931-796-5096	TROUSDALE	615-374-2114
DECATUR	731-852-3911	LINCOLN	931-433-4522	UNICOI	423-743-1850
DEKALB	615-597-4935	LOUDON	865-986-4823	UNION	865-992-5212
DICKSON	615-446-8041	MACON	615-666-3325	VAN BUREN	931-946-2118
DYER	731-285-2802	MADISON	731-423-6000	WARREN	931-473-7863
FAYETTE	901-465-3456	MARION	942-423-2525	WASHINGTON	423-788-1414
FENTRESS	931-879-8142	MARSHALL	931-359-6122	WAYNE	931-722-3613
FRANKLIN	931-967-2331	MAURY	931-388-5151	WEAKLY	731-364-5454
GIBSON	731-892-3714	MCMINN	423-725-5620	WHITE	931-836-2700
GILES	931-363-0911	MCNAIRY	731-645-1000	WILLIAMSON	615-790-5550
GRAINGER	865-828-3613	MEIGS	423-334-5268	WILSON	615-444-1412
GREENE	423-798-1800	MONROE	423-442-2268		
GRUNDY	931-692-3460	MONTGOMERY	931-552-1011		
HAMBLEN	423-586-3781	MOORE	931-759-7323		
HAMILTON	423-622-0022	MORGAN	423-346-6262		

APPENDIX E
Clinic Locations with Crisis Team Numbers

<u>LOCATION</u>	<u>ADDRESS</u>	<u>PHONE</u>	<u>PHARMACY</u>	<u>Crisis Contact</u>	<u>MCRT Team</u>
Chattanooga, TN	6110 Shallowford Rd, Ste B	(423) 499-1031	Madison	800-704-2651	VBH
Clarksville HCC	511 8th St.	(931) 920-7200	Clarksville	877-463-6518	CTN
Cleveland	4160 N. Ocoee St., Ste 8	(423) 464-4357	Madison	800-704-2651	VBH
CVN	775 Weatherly Drive, Ste. A	(931) 221-3850	Clarksville	877-463-6518	CTN
Dickson	6000 Ramsey Way	(615) 446-3797	Madison	877-463-6518	CTN
Estill Springs	416 South Main St.	(931) 649-3408	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Fayetteville	2241 Thornton Taylor Pkwy	(931) 433-6456	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Vero Center	1921 Ransom Place	(615) 279-6700	Vero	855-274-7471	MH CO-OP
Gallatin	332 Sumner Hall Dr.	(615) 460-4500	Madison	800-704-2651	VBH
Hohenwald	912 Summertown Highway	(931) 796-5916	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Lawrenceburg	1090 Old Florence Rd.	(931) 762-6505	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Lewisburg	1601 Nashville Highway	(931) 359-5802	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Madison	620 South Gallatin Rd.	(615) 460-4300	Madison	855-274-7471	MH CO-OP
Pulaski	1002 Brindley Dr.	(931) 363-5439	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Shelbyville	604 South Wall St.	(931) 684-0522	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Springfield	713 Cheatham St.	(615) 463-6200	Clarksville	877-463-6518	CTN
Tullahoma	1803 North Jackson	(931) 461-1300	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
Waynesboro	418 South Main St.	(931) 722-3644	Vero	877-463-6518	CTN
White Avenue	2400 White Avenue	(615) 460-4200	Madison	855-274-7471	MH CO-OP

APPENDIX F

Youth Villages Contacts by County

CRISIS LINE FOR 18 AND UNDER

County	MCRT	Number	County	MCRT	Number
Anderson	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Lake	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Bedford	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222	Lauderdale	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Benton	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Lawrence	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Bledsoe	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225	Lewis	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Blount	Helen Ross McNabb Center	865-539-2409	Lincoln	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Bradley	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225	Louden	Helen Ross McNabb Center	865-539-2409
Campbell	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Macon	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Cannon	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222	Madison	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Carroll	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Marion	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Carter	Frontier Health	877-928-9062	Marshall	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Cheatham	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Maury	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Chester	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	McMinn	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Claiborne	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	McNairy	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Clay	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Meigs	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Cocke	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Monroe	Helen Ross McNabb Center	865-539-2409
Coffee	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222	Montgomery	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Crockett	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Moore	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Cumberland	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Morgan	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Davidson	Mental Health Cooperative	615-726-0125	Obion	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Decatur	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Overton	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
DeKalb	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Perry	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Dickson	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Pickett	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Dyer	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Polk	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Fayette	Youth Villages-Memphis Region	866-791-9226	Putnam	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Fentress	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Rhea	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Franklin	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225	Roane	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Gibson	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Robertson	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Giles	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222	Rutherford	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Grainger	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Scott	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Greene	Frontier Health	877-928-9062	Sequatchie	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Grundy	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225	Sevier	Helen Ross McNabb Center	865-539-2409
Hamblen	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Shelby	Youth Villages-Memphis Region	866-791-9226
Hamilton	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225	Smith	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Hancock	Frontier Health	877-928-9062	Stewart	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Hardeman	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Sullivan	Frontier Health	877-928-9062
Hardin	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Sumner	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Hawkins	Frontier Health	877-928-9062	Tipton	Youth Villages-Memphis Region	866-791-9226
Haywood	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Trousdale	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221
Henderson	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Unicoi	Frontier Health	877-928-9062
Henry	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227	Union	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Hickman	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222	Van Buren	Youth Villages-Southeast Region	866-791-9225
Houston	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Warren	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Humphreys	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Washington	Frontier Health	877-928-9062
Jackson	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221	Wayne	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
Jefferson	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224	Weakley	Youth Villages-Rural West Region	866-791-9227
Johnson	Frontier Health	877-928-9062	White	Youth Villages-East Region	866-791-9224
Knox	Helen Ross McNabb Center	865-539-2409	Williamson	Youth Villages-South Middle Region	866-791-9222
			Wilson	Youth Villages-North Middle Region	866-791-9221

Things to remember:

- ❖ **Client must be appropriate for telehealth services and sign consent to treatment**
- ❖ **Client must sign Communication Request Authorization and agree to text and email communication**
- ❖ **Staff must complete required training and attest to review of Telehealth Procedures upon completion (standard of practice)**
- ❖ **Client must be located in the state of TN at the time of the visit unless their clinician or psychiatric provider is licensed in the state where the client is present**
- ❖ **Privacy for both the client and the provider is essential**
- ❖ **Client must acknowledge review of Telehealth Guidelines for Clients at first session**
- ❖ **At the first telehealth encounter there must be documentation of review of expectations, discussion of emergency plan and confirmation of the identity of the client (photo ID); unless client is known to provider**
- ❖ **EHR format will capture client and provider location at time of session**
 - Telehlth Client in Clinic Video/Audio
 - Telehlth Client Not Home or Clinic Video/Audio
 - Telehlth Client in Home Video/Audio
- ❖ **If telehealth client is not at home, progress note must capture specific location of the client (at a minimum the county). In addition, contact phone number should be confirmed in the event of technical failure or clinical emergency.**
 - **Ask client:**
 - “Where are you today?”
 - “Can I confirm your contact phone number?”